David García-León

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Contact Information

Ministerio de Agricultura, Pesca y Alimentación
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Personal Information

Born: Cabo de Palos, 9 June 1983 — Nationality: Spanish

Current Appointment

Scientific Adviser to the Minister (2025–present)
Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries and Food, Government of Spain

I advise on the science–policy interface, translating scientific evidence into inputs for ministerial decision-making across agriculture, rural development, innovation and climate-related policy.

International Science & Policy Roles

Coordinating Lead Author (AR7), Chapter 11: Europe (2025–present)
Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)
Working Group II on Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability

I lead the assessment of climate risks and adaptation in Europe, coordinating a multidisciplinary author team and synthesising evidence for policy-relevant outputs.

***External Adviser* – European Climate Risk Assessment (EUCRA-2)** (2026–present)
European Environment Agency

I provide scientific and methodological advice to support EUCRA-2.

***Expert Evaluator* – Horizon Europe (CINEA, HADEA)** (2026–present)
European Commission

I evaluate research and innovation proposals under Horizon Europe's Cluster 5: Climate, Energy and Mobility and the EU Mission on Adaptation to Climate Change.

Education

Ph.D., Quantitative Economics. University of Alicante, Spain (2017)
Dissertation: Three Essays in Climate Change Economics

M.Sc., Economics and Finance. CEMFI, Madrid, Spain (2009)
M.Sc., Finance. ESCP-EAP, Madrid, Spain (2007)
B.A., International Economics. Manchester Metropolitan University, United Kingdom (2006)
B.A., Economics. University of Murcia, Spain (2006)

Previous Appointments

Scientific Officer (2020–2025)
European Commission, DG Joint Research Centre
Climate Change Impact and Adaptation Policy Analyst
Economics of Climate Change, Energy & Transport Unit (JRC.C6)

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Researcher (2016–2020)
Ca' Foscari University and Euro-Mediterranean Center on Climate Change, Venice, Italy
Project: WATER DROP – Droughts and Water Scarcity in the EU: Economic Impacts, Adaptation, Policy Implications and Integrated Assessment Modelling

Research Assistant (2009–2011)
Bank of Spain, DG Research, Madrid, Spain
Euro area real-time GDP forecast
Fiscal developments monitoring in the euro area
Pension system reforms assessment

Visiting Positions

European Commission, DG for Climate Action, Adaptation & Resilience to Climate Change Unit (CLIMA.E1). Brussels, Belgium (Mar 2023)

European Commission, DG Joint Research Centre, Food Security Unit (JRC.D5). Ispra, Italy (Sep–Dec 2017 and Jun 2019)

Publications

- Ioannou, L.G., Tsoutsoubi, L., Mantzios, K., Gkikas, G., Agaliotis, G., Koutedakis, Y., García-León, D., Havenith, G., Liang, J., Arkolakis, C., Glaser, J., Kenny, G., Mekjavic, I., Nybo, L. and A.D. Flouris (2025). Labor productivity beyond output: The role of work time loss. *Journal of Occupational and Environmental Medicine*. [doi]

- Galmarini, S., Román Cuesta, R.M., Dentener, F., Ruiz Moreno, A., Alessi, L. et al. (2025). Raising Awareness of Earth System Tipping Points: Implications for EU Governance - Workshop report, Publications Office of the European Union, Luxembourg, JRC141821. [doi]

- Ioannou, L.G., Tsoutsoubi, L., Mantzios, K., Gkikas, G., Agaliotis, G., Koutedakis, Y., García-León, D., Havenith, G., Liang, J., Arkolakis, C., Glaser, J., Kenny, G., Mekjavic, I., Nybo, L. and A.D. Flouris (2025). The impact of workplace heat and cold on work time loss. *Journal of Occupational and Environmental Medicine* 67(6), 393-399. [doi]

- García-León, D., Matei, N.A., Batista e Silva, F., Barranco, R., Dosio, A., and J.C. Ciscar (2025). European tourism demand in the face of climate change: Asymmetric impacts, demand reallocation, and deseasonalisation strategies. ***Environmental Research Letters*** 20, 024043. [doi]

- Masselot, P., Mistry, M.N., Rao, S., Huber, V., Monteiro, A., Samoli, E., Stafoggia, M., de'Donato, F., García-León, D., Ciscar, J.C., Feyen, L., Schneider, A., Katsouyanni, K., Vicedo-Cabrera, A., Aunan, K., and A. Gasparrini (2025). Estimating future heat-related and cold-related mortality under climate change, demographic and adaptation scenarios in 854 European cities. ***Nature Medicine***. [doi]

- García-León, D., Masselot, P., Mistry, M.N., Gasparrini, A., Motta, C., Feyen, L., and J.C. Ciscar (2024). Temperature-related mortality burden and projected change in 1368 European regions: a modelling study. ***The Lancet Public Health*** 9(9), e644-e653 [doi] [Data]

  Coverage: The Guardian, El País, The Times, La Repubblica, El Mundo | Altmetric: 99th percentile

- Shahpari, G., Ashena, M., Martínez-Cruz A.L., and D. García-León (2023). Implications from agriculture based climate change scenarios on the Iranian economy - A computable general equilibrium approach. Theoretical and Applied Climatology. [doi]

- Matei, N.A., García-León, D., Dosio, A., Barranco, R., Batista e Silva, F., and J.C. Ciscar (2023). Regional impact of climate change on European tourism demand. JRC Technical Report, 131508. [doi] [Data]

  Coverage: El País, TVE, BBC, Der Spiegel, Politico

- Masselot, P., Mistry, M.N., Vanoli, J., Schneider, R., Iungman, T., García-León, D., Ciscar, J.C., Feyen, L., Orru, H., Urban, A., Breittner, S., Huber, V., Schneider, A., Samoli, E., Stafoggia, M., Armstrong, B., Nieuwenhuijsen, M., Vicedo-Cabrera, A., Gasparrini, A., MCC Research Network, and EXHAUSTION project (2023). Excess mortality attributed to heat and cold: a health impact assessment study in 854 cities in Europe. ***The Lancet Planetary Health*** 7(4), e271-e281. [doi]

- Mistry, M., Schneider, R., Masselot, P., Royé, D., Armstrong, B., Kyselý, J., Orru, H., Sera, F., Tong, S., Lavigne, E., Urban, A., Madureira, J., García-León, D., Ibarreta, D., Ciscar, J.C., Feyen, L., de Schrijver, E., Coelho, M., Pascal, M., Tobias, A., MCC Research Network, Guo, Y., Vicedo-Cabrera, A., and A. Gasparrini (2022). Comparison of weather station and climate reanalysis data for modelling temperature-related mortality. *Scientific Reports* 12, 5178. [doi]

- Shahpari, G., Sadeghi, H., Ashena, M., and D. García-León (2022). Drought effects on the Iranian economy: a computable general equilibrium approach. *Environment, Development and Sustain-*

ability 24, 4110-4127. [doi]

- García-León, D., Casanueva, A., Standardi, G., Burgstall, A., Flouris, A.D., and L. Nybo (2021). Current and projected regional economic impacts of heatwaves in Europe. ***Nature Communications*** 12, 5807. [doi]

  Coverage: The Guardian, El Mundo, The New York Times, CNN, El País | Altmetric: 99th percentile

- García-León, D., Standardi, G., and A. Staccione (2021). An integrated approach for the estimation of agricultural drought costs. *Land Use Policy* 100, 104923. [doi]

- García-León, D., López-Lozano, R., Toreti, A., and M. Zampieri (2020). Local-scale cereal yield forecasting in Italy: Lessons from different statistical models and spatial aggregations. *Agronomy* 10(6), 809. [doi]

- García-León, D., Contreras, S., and J. Hunink (2019). Comparison of meteorological and satellite-based drought indices as yield predictors of Spanish cereals. *Agricultural Water Management* 213:388–396. [doi]

Working Papers and Policy Articles

"Impactos y riesgos del cambio climático en España: Una breve panorámica", with Juan Carlos Císcar, *Papeles de Energía* 16, February 2022. [link]

"Cambio Climático y Política Económica: Estado del arte y retos a corto plazo", *Nada es Gratis*, May 2020. [link]

"Adapting to climate change: An analysis under uncertainty", Nota di Lavoro 10.2016, Milan, Italy: Fondazione Eni Enrico Mattei, 2016. [link]

"Weather and Income: Lessons from the main European regions", Nota di Lavoro 39.2015, Milan, Italy: Fondazione Eni Enrico Mattei, 2015. [link]

"Stock accumulation in the euro area during the Great Recession", ("La acumulación de existencias en el Área del Euro durante la Gran Recesión.") with Pablo Burriel. Bank of Spain's Economic Bulletin, March 2011. [link]

"Pension system reforms in some EMU countries", ("Reformas de los sistemas de pensiones en algunos países de la UEM.") with Esther Gordo and Marta Manrique. Bank of Spain's Economic Bulletin, July-August 2011. [link]

"A state-space approach to the evolution of house prices in Spain", 2009

Teaching Experience

2019-20 Statistics II [ET2022], Department of Economics, Ca' Foscari University of Venice
2019-20 Macroeconomics [ET2029], Department of Management, Ca' Foscari University of Venice
2018-19 Mathematical Methods for Climate Change Analysis [PHD087], Department of Environmental Sciences, Informatics and Statistics, Ca' Foscari University of Venice
2018-19 Statistics I [ET2022], Department of Economics, Ca' Foscari University of Venice
2018-19 Macroeconomics I-II [ET2017], Department of Economics, Ca' Foscari University of Venice
2016 Tools for Applied Statistical Analysis, Department of Economics, UCAM University
2013-14 Introduction to Statistics and Econometrics, Department of Economics, University of Alicante
2013 Introduction to GAUSS: An application for cointegrated variables detection, Department of Economics, Technical University of Cartagena

Seminars, Conferences, and Invited Presentations

2026: IPCC Lead Author Meeting (Nassau, Bahamas); Instituto Español de Oceanografía - IEO (Madrid, Spain); Instituto Nacional de Investigación y Tecnología Agraria y Alimentaria - INIA (Madrid, Spain); Oficina Nacional de Asesoramiento Científico - ONAC (Madrid, Spain); XLV Jornadas de Economía de la Salud (Seville, Spain); La aplicación de la futura PAC y la nueva tecnología agraria: Eficiencia y Rentabilidad (Valladolid, Spain)
2025: Oficina Andaluza Cambio Climático (Seville, Spain); Universitat Rovira i Virgili (Tarragona, Spain); Asociación Española Economía Agroalimentaria (Granada, Spain); Convención para el

Pacto de Estado frente a la Emergencia Climática (Ponferrada, Spain); IPCC Lead Author Meeting (Paris, France)
2024: European Climate and Health Observatory (Brussels, Belgium); Universitat Rovira i Virgili (Tarragona, Spain); Oficina Andaluza Cambio Climático (Seville, Spain); ACCREU Annual Meeting (Bilbao, Spain); Tourism Innovation Summit (Seville, Spain); Raising Awareness of Earth System Tipping Points: Implications for EU Governance (Brussels, Belgium)
2023: International Labour Organization's International Conference on Occupational Heat Stress (Doha, Qatar); Cross-sectoral ISIMIP-PROCLIAS Workshop (Prague, Czechia); Workshop on migration, climate change and economic growth (Zaragoza, Spain); I Jornadas Economía y Cambio Climático (Oviedo, Spain); ¿Qué hace la UE por la ciencia? (Seville, Spain); European Commission's Tourism Advisory Committee (online)
2022: Joint Research Centre (Seville, Spain); Future, Risks and Impacts of Intense Mediterranean Cyclones (Baeza, Spain); Cross-sectoral ISIMIP-PROCLIAS Workshop (Potsdam, Germany); European Regional Science Association (Pécs, Hungary); Universidad Loyola (Seville, Spain); Asociación Española de Climatología (Santiago de Compostela, Spain)
2021: Integrated Assessment Modeling Consortium (online)
2020: Italian Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Brescia, Italy); UK Network of Environmental Economists (London, UK)
2019: Italian Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Udine, Italy); JRC Alumni Association (Brussels, Belgium); Marie Curie Alumni Association (Vienna, Austria); CMCC - Euro-Mediterranean Center on Climate Change (Bologna, Italy); Drought and Water Scarcity: Addressing current and future challenges (Oxford, UK); Leibniz-Institut für Ost- und Südosteuropaforschung Summer Academy (Tutzing, Germany); BC3 - Basque Centre for Climate Change (Bilbao, Spain); Joint Research Centre, European Commission (Seville, Spain)
2018: Italian Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Turin, Italy); Euro-Mediterranean Center on Climate Change (Venice, Italy); European Society for Agronomy (Geneva, Switzerland); Spanish-Portuguese Association of Natural and Environmental Resource Economics (Madrid, Spain); Conference on Econometric Models of Climate Change (Rome, Italy); X Jornadas de Usuarios de R (Murcia, Spain)
2017: Fondazione Eni Enrico Mattei (2); Joint Research Centre (Ispra, Italy)
2016: Spanish Economic Association (Bilbao, Spain)
2015: European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Helsinki, Finland); University of Cardiff; International conference on drought: Research and science-policy interfacing (Valencia, Spain)
2013: Technical University of Cartagena (Spain)
2011: Bank of Spain (2); European Central Bank (Frankfurt, Germany)
2010: Bank of Spain
2009: CEMFI

Theses Supervised

Giada Povellato (Undergraduate, Ca' Foscari University of Venice, 2020)
Alessia Facincani (Undergraduate, Ca' Foscari University of Venice, 2020)

Grants and Awards

Erasmus+ Teaching Fellowship (ICM), Ca'Foscari University of Venice, 2020
Assistant Professorship Positive Evaluation (PEP, ANECA), 2019
Marie Curie Alumni Association, Micro Media Grant, 2017
Marie Skłodowska-Curie European Fellowship, Individual Fellowship (168,277€), 2016
Exemption of tuition fees, CEMFI, Madrid, 2007
Stephen Jones' Memorial prize for excellence, Manchester Metropolitan University, UK, 2006
Premio Extraordinario Fin de Carrera (Excellence Award), University of Murcia, 2006
Fellowship member, Socrates-Erasmus programme, Manchester, United Kingdom, 2005
Grant for living expenses abroad, Fundación Cajamurcia, 2005

Academic Service

Referee for: *Agricultural Water Management, Agriculture (2), Agronomy (3), Climatic Change (4), Economies (2), Environmental Research Communications (2), Environmental Research Letters (5),*

European Environment Agency, International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, IPCC AR6 (2), JRC Review Board (6), Nature, Nature Communications: Medicine, Science of the Total Environment (2), Science Advances, Sustainability (2), The Lancet Planetary Health, Theoretical and Applied Climatology, UCL Open: Environment

Organiser: JRC.C6 Seminar Series (2021-2022, 2022-2023, 2023-2024)

Languages

Spanish: Native
English: Advanced (C2). CPE, University of Cambridge (2013)
Italian: Advanced (C1)
German: Intermediate (B1). Zertifikat Deutsch (2011)

Computer Skills

Artificial Intelligence: GPT-based tools, Codex, Claude Code, GPT@JRC
Coding: R, MATLAB, Stata, Python, GEMPACK, Google Earth Engine
Data: NetCDF, HDF, GeoTIFF, GeoJSON, GIS, ENVI, IDL
Web: Jekyll, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, d3.js
Text: LaTeX, Markdown, Knitr

References

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